All Was Well

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58557517.

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra)

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by sunflowersinmysleep

Summary

Despite the war being over, the visions of a violent past still haunt Adora, but luckily she has the love of those closest to her to help her get through it.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Adora slides her hands glide down the smooth silkiness of her white dress, bumping against the decorative golden embroidery around the waist. And then she adjusts the delicate crown atop her head for the tenth time in the last few minutes.

She can feel her clammy hands slipping against the cool metal of the crown, jewels tinkling against the tips of her fingernails. She peers at her rippling reflection in the waterfall, glancing at her appearance in the constant moving water.

The reason for all this fussing? Scorpia's ball. For some reason it's all causing Adora's adrenaline to spike, a sense of dread rising in her throat.

She's suddenly surprised by a loud noise coming from the entrance behind her. Jumping, she turns to the door, her stance ready to fight.

From the door emerges Catra who tumbles out, hair awry, with Glimmer in tow, bedazzled brush in hand.

"Just let me brush it!" She hears glimmer say, giggling.

"No!" Catra exclaims, laughter rippling through her throat.

Catra quickly finds herself next to Adora, using her as a shield from Glimmer's oncoming brush attacks. Glimmer swerves around Adora, uncaring of her presence in pursuit of reaching Catra's unkempt hair.

"Just let me brush it." Glimmer says.

The two of them continue jostling around her. Unfamiliar laughter of their new shared friendship echoing off the walls.

"No! Don't let her touch me she's gonna torture me!" Catra exclaims.

“Do you always have to be this dramatic?” Glimmer asks, the question irrelevant to the joy emanating from her voice. Then Adora sees another figure emerge from the entrance.

Bow enters, “Come on guys. If we’re late to Scorpia’s first ball, she’s gonna kill us.” He says with no trace of fear lingering in his voice, enhancing the meaninglessness of the threat.

Glimmer immediately falls to his side, comfortable, and leans her head into his shoulder.

“Fine,” Glimmer says, smiling contentedly, “You’re off the hook, this time.”

Adora feels Catra come up behind her, hands on her shoulders, and from the corner of her eye she sees Catra sticking her tongue out at Glimmer.

A soft and silent moment of tenderness passes between them and Adora relaxes. Despite the unfamiliarity of it all, she remembers that this is her life now. All is well and love is rampant. Bow and Glimmer are deeply in love and spend all their time being entirely romantic and mushy. While her and Catra are exploring their relationship with one another and committing to learning how to love.

The fear in her bones suddenly alleviates, and she wonders why she had felt so tense. They’re about to go to Scorpia’s first ball after the liberation of the Fright Zone from The Hoard. She is so excited to see her and Perfuma’s new decor. Adora has been told that Perfuma has covered it with so many with plants that you can’t barely tell it used to be the Hoard. Of which Adora is grateful because it means that she won’t have to face the place in which all her and Catra’s childhood trauma exists within.

Bow and Glimmer turn away, still entirely wrapped in one another, and head to the door to leave. Catra emerges from Adora’s right, her matching white and gold coat hanging loosely over her

shoulder from her right hand. Then she turns towards Adora, thrusts out her other hand and says:

“You coming?”

Adora’s heart drops to her stomach, every nerve in her body freezing. She’s brought back to that moment. The moment she almost died.

Catra, frozen in time, only a facade created by Horde Prime. Adora’s vision breaks and all she sees his the sickly green of Horde Prime overtaking her vision and distorting it. She feels no semblance of joy or peace, but only the fear of that moment before she nearly lost everything. She feels the poison of Horde Prime again, seeping through her veins, sucking out the life from her body.

Adora’s heart begins to beat rapidly again, a pace similar to that of a hummingbird’s. Her sweating is back, more intense than ever, dripping down the back of her neck. Her breath comes in short spurts, never feeling for a second that she can take a full breath.

All the while Catra’s hand remains there. Adora fears that if she moves, if she tries to reach out for her love, that she will dissipate into a pixelated oblivion and disappear forever. She can’t do that. She cannot lose Catra again. She will not lose her again.

Then she hears a faint, “Adora?”

She snaps out of her reverie, heart still pounding, and turns up to see Catra’s brilliant amber and blue eyes pouring into hers.

“Hey,” Catra says, sharp, but it’s as if she’s hearing it all underwater, “are you okay?”

Catra softly reaches out to her, gentle hands touching her shoulders. Solid, firm, never-ending Catra and her presence. Adora focuses on the steady feeling of Catra touching her, holding her, grounding her.

It’s not real, Adora tells herself, Catra is here.

Adora takes a deep breath, forcing herself to look at Catra in the eyes.

Catra, her Catra, who is really here, who is safe. Horde Prime is gone. I am safe, she thinks. These thoughts and the feeling of Catra touching her all slowly bringing her back to reality.

She feels her breaths slowing, her vision coming back into focus.

“Yeah,” Adora breathes, “just,” she swallows, “had some Deja vu.”

Catra looks puzzled, “Deja-who?” Then laughs, “You’re so stupid.” She pushes Adora playfully, laughing.

In a muscle memory reaction, Adora pushes Catra back. “You’re stupid!” She giggles, continuing to play-fight.

Her and Catra push each other for a couple of seconds, gently fighting one another, but it never lasts long anymore because next thing Adora knows Catra is pulling her in close and pressing their lips against one another.

It took some time for Catra and Adora to get used to physical affection with one another. Each day they would push their own internal boundaries, trying to get closer to the other, for the blissful outcome of intimacy far outweighing the initial hesitancy they have.

Now, when they’re alone Catra can’t help but touch Adora all the time. If no one else is around they have their hands constantly glued to one another.

Adora can’t complain as she loves every moment with Catra, and now this kiss eases her further back into reality, the visions of before becoming an easily forgettable past.

Yet, not entirely forgettable, as the effects of Horde Prime’s violence will continue to reverberate through the universe for

centuries. Adora and Catra's past themselves being defined by Hordak, whose desire, their entire childhood, being to appease Horde Prime himself.

But, Adora does not wish for his presence to be a constant in her life, and through the practice of love and therapy, they're all slowly moving through it.

But that does not stop moments like this, ones like this that pierce right through the joy and bring out fear. But, when her Catra is holding her close and kissing her, and it becomes easy to allow her love to take over.

As Adora kisses Catra, enjoying the feel of her lips against her own, she realizes that, despite Horde Prime still lingering in her psyche, she has managed to defy him in the greatest way possible. She has lived in a way that has resulted in her truest fantasy becoming a reality. The vision that he used against her in her near-final hours, that he deemed would never come to fruition, finally did. She is in love, with Catra, living in a way that allows her to honour both the Adora and She-ra parts in her life. She is surrounded by friends and family, and is the happiest she has ever been in her entire life.

No matter how much fear she might feel, the best form of rebellion she can practice is to live her life with love at the forefront.

Catra suddenly pulls back, her velvet lips parting from Adora's. Adora leans in for more but Catra presses softly into her chest to hold her back.

"You're okay," Catra says, locking her gaze. "You're safe. I'm here, you're here and nothing can hurt us."

Adora let's out a deep breath, looking into Catra's multi-coloured eyes, those eyes that hold all that history, all that love, all that devotion. The eyes of her childhood, her fears, her hopes and dreams. The eyes of the person that means the most in the world

to her, the eyes of the person that tried to kill her, and the eyes of the person who Adora would destroy a fascist space dictator for if it meant that she could only have another moment with her. The eyes of her perfect pairing, of her soulmate.

“I know,” she says.

End Notes

This is my first ever publication on Ao3! I thought of this when I finished She-ra years ago but never went through with it. Not the most original, but I thought it would be fun to imagine what would go through her mind if this vision did occur to her in real life. A sort of homage to the series and a glimpse into the possible future.

Hope you all enjoy it !

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!